A Thorough Examination

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Mature

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by AkaUsa

Summary

While traveling to Mystacor, Castaspella realizes nobody checked to see if Shadow Weaver had been overtaken by Horde Prime. Correcting that is in order but she's not prepared for how far Shadow Weaver is ready to take things.

Castaspella still didn't understand how Shadow Weaver had managed to stay in the Rebellion for so long, especially with Horde Prime's army having already caused them such terrible losses. Someone who had changed sides that many times couldn't be trusted one minute, which was exactly why she had accepted to follow her in this wild search for the sealed magic of Etheria.

In order to ascertain whether Mystacor was entirely controlled by Prime, Shadow Weaver would send one of her dark magic spies to check the place from afar. While she looked through its eye for a safe way to the underground secret passages, Castaspella had to monitor the vicinity and guard her unprotected body. They'd need to stand fairly close to the magical floating island to do so, since Shadow Weaver couldn't count on the powers of the Black Garnet like she had done previously to infiltrate the place.

It felt like it had happened ages ago, yet this didn't seem any less ironic to Castaspella that this time, she was going to help her enemy get inside the kingdom she was in charge of.

She watched Shadow Weaver trace a spell on the ground of a small clearing, then sit down to meditate, hair and shadows fluttering along her thin frame eerily. Castaspella shivered and her thoughts went to her brother, who had defended that cursed sorcerer for so long after she had been banished from Mystacor, arguing that her intentions had only been for the best, though her actions were wrong. He had been blinded by their close teacher-student relationship and couldn't see that she was mainly after power. Only upon learning about her joining the Horde had his faith truly been broken and then he had died, or so they thought back then.

The memory of him had been painful all those years and even now that they had found Mycah alive, thinking of her brother only brought bitterness to her tongue again, for losing him so quickly to Prime's mind control. Castaspella would have given up many things to have him back with her instead of Shadow Weaver, who had done all she could to creep her out since they had begun

wandering through the woods. Flashes of memories from the past days of dealing with her kept popping in her mind, crawling at it and not letting go, like they were trying to tell her something.

That was when it hit her.

Back when the remaining Rebellion members met with Castaspella, they had looked at the back of her neck to confirm that she was still with them but when Shadow Weaver had appeared from who knew where, nobody had thought to do the same with her. The conversation had naturally turned sour the minute she had spoken, her toxic presence distracting everyone and sparing her from being embedded in ice. Meaning they had absolutely no idea whether Shadow Weaver had been turned to the enemy or not.

Castaspella quickly looked around the clearing. If she was controlled by Prime, then Shadow Weaver had surely been leading her into an ambush and her spying shadow was actually being sent to Prime's allies while Castaspella waited, unconscious of the risks.

For now, nothing strange seemed to move around them, only the sound of the wind blowing the branches of the trees could be heard. Slowly, she circled around the still body of Shadow Weaver to approach her back. There was only one way of checking if Prime had gotten to her.

As softly as she could, Castaspella leaned down to pull on the red collar of her robe. Despite knowing that simply touching a sorcerer in a trance wasn't usually enough to have them notice, she could feel a cold sweat running over her skin and her heart was beating deafeningly in her chest. She delicately grabbed the flowing black hair, thick and slithery against her palm, and pushed it to the side, revealing a perfectly intact nape.

Dubious, she brushed her fingers against it, trying to sense if something felt wrong. She had not directly seen this chip the other Rebellion members had mentioned, which complicated her

endeavor. Maybe it was supposed to be placed a little more down the spine, she wondered, pushing her finger a bit lower. The greyish skin felt somewhat rough when she rubbed it.

"Now, what are you trying to do, I wonder?"

With a jump, Castaspella drew back, nearly swearing in the process of freaking out over Shadow Weaver's damn timing in regaining her senses. Perhaps she had even been conscious of what was happening much earlier than that but had chosen to wait for the most embarrassing moment to say something.

"What do you think I'm doing?! The way you've been acting is totally suspicious! It's only natural to check if you haven't joined the enemy's ranks!"

"Suspicious, really?" she answered with that sultry, sarcastic voice that drew Castaspella mad.

"Yes, really! How you move and talk, even the fact that you're asking me to stop you if you try to take the magic for yourself! Feels like you're buttering me up more than anything. Indeed, you could be trying to sugar-coat the truth to lead me into a trap!"

In reality, part of it seemed totally in line with Shadow Weaver and acting suspicious was definitely something natural coming from her but it just made it all the more infuriating to Castaspella that she still couldn't understand what was going on. Over the last few weeks of the Rebellion falling apart, she had been careful to second-guess every gesture and word from her, in order to estimate any possible hidden goals Shadow Weaver could have. Based on the tone of her voice when she talked to her, the number of times she had made physical contact or gotten into her personal space, Castaspella's only guess right now was that it somehow involved seducing her.

Of course, this had sounded like an inane conspiracy theory at first, but the more she thought about it, the more obvious it became. The repeated whispers in her ears to bring a blush on

her face and the brushing of her fingers against her hand to get chills to run along her skin should have been proof enough.

Castaspella hadn't said anything before; obviously, she didn't want to risk giving the opportunity to Shadow Weaver to deny it and try to make her appear delusional, or worse. Right now though, they were alone together and her survival depended on whether she could get to the bottom of it.

Shadow Weaver didn't bother moving from her sitting position to give her a long, inquisitive look. Despite the mask hiding her features, Castaspella could somewhat picture her eyes narrowing, and her whole body tensed while waiting for her next word or move.

"Fine then, I'll let you finish what you have started, if that'll assuage your fears."

As she talked, Shadow Weaver started removing the upper part of the cloth draping her body.

What she said didn't quite register immediately to Castaspella. Only when the first layers of clothes slip from the body that her robes had been hidding quite well did the blood rise to her face. Shadow Weaver stood up, letting the red fabric fall on the forest ground, and Castaspella found herself unable to speak or act.

"Well then, continue your examination," Shadow Weaver offered, arms raised.

This was such a scandalous new proof added to her theory that Castaspella was even more lost on the best way to proceed from there. The point seemed to be to taunt or provoke her, so admitting embarrassment or attraction would be her loss and failure. In that case, she ought to act unbothered and accept the offer as if this show of nakedness didn't matter one bit. Strenghtening her resolve, she coughed a bit to bolster her voice.

"Alright, then. I suppose it's true we don't know if the chip is necessarily put on the neck. It could be anywhere."

The last sentence made Shadow Weaver sneer and Castaspella tried to ignore it while she moved around to look at her under various angles. Observing her with a clear eye was difficult when she could feel her gaze watching right back intently; it made Castaspella uneasy of where her eyes stopped and how it would be taken.

She attempted to avoid looking too much at her breasts and ass, even though she knew she should have paid attention, given a chip could have easily been hidden between them.

"Raise your arms," she asked instead and Shadow Weaver followed without any retort.

"Shouldn't you come closer? You might miss something if you only look from afar," she said after a while of watching Castaspella still examining her from the safe distance behind the magic circle she had drawn.

Gulping down, she took a step forward. She knew it was foolish and dangerous, approaching further this monster who beckoned to her like one from a fairytale would attract its prey, but she could hardly be reassured either if she wasn't able to check thoroughly.

Castaspella bent down slightly and looked under her armpits. Thin black hair covered this part of the grey skin which looked rough and cracked in places. From up close, she could see many blemishes, from dark spots to small scars. Her veins, where she could discern them, appeared black too, like the shadows she so loved.

To better see inside the fold of the arm, Castaspella pushed Shadow Weaver's elbow further up without thinking, recoiling like she had been hurt by the contact the moment after.

"Go on, you can touch if you need. I understand the necessity."

This was just another taunt, another trap, and yet what choice did Castaspella have, if she wanted to be certain nothing was amiss?

She didn't know how well this chip could be hidden, especially with Shadow Weaver's talent for illusions.

Carefully, she touched the skin with the tip of her fingers only. It didn't feel as dry as she had expected to, from the look of leathery old parchment it had. There was a bit of moistness to the armpit and a faint smell of sweat. No matter how fiendish Shadow Weaver appeared, she was still a person of flesh and blood under all the dark powers she wield. Castaspella pulled on the skin a bit but saw nothing strange on that side. She turned the arm around to look at it under all angles, including watching both sides of the hand. The familiar presence of magic could be felt clearly in her palm when she pressed her thumb on it and this energy tickled her all over the moment her fingers brushed against Shadow Weaver's thin knuckles.

After finishing her examination of one arm, Castaspella moved to the other, observing pretty much the same results.

Shadow Weaver had exposed her neck by sweeping her long dark hair to the front of her body, so she asked her to pull it away, since nothing appeared to be on her back in-between the bony shoulder blades or the sharp bumps of her spine that looked rough to the touch. Castaspella hadn't really thought about trying to touch it, since that wasn't needed, but the image still popped up to her.

It took a second for a reaction to follow her demand and this was enough for her mind to fill with ideas of how the thick hair would feel between her fingers again if she had to brush it aside herself. However, Shadow Weaver complied and pulled it back, revealing tiny nipples dark like ink and more scars. Her breasts sagged a little but weren't big enough to hide much of anything under or between them, now that Castaspells looked from up-close. Yet there was a temptation to touch, to make sure with her fingers she didn't miss anything, even though her eyes should have been enough to check.

She did pull on the skin around the navel instead, as if to relieve herself from the feeling by looking there. The sight of the small, stretched hole between her fingers had her insides twist shamefully.

Quickly, Castaspella rose back to face level, eye to eye with the glint of Shadow Weaver's red mask.

"I'm... going to need to see your face."

This time, it took much longer for her to respond and Castaspella was left having to sustain her glare until Shadow Weaver finally relented.

Without the mask, her gaze was less intimidating, although the look of her eyes certainly was unusual. She had seen them before obviously, back in Mystacor when Shadow Weaver still wore her old name but Castaspella's youth at the time and the decades that separated them from then meant that she wasn't sure whether those eyes had been exactly the same at the time or if black magic had changed them somewhat. The scars on her face, at least, she was pretty sure hadn't been there.

Castaspella pulled her hand under Shadow Weaver's chin, feeling for anything unusual as they kept staring at each other. She couldn't escape her gaze and so, she had to check with her fingers, sliding along the sides of her neck half-hidden by hair before rising up to touch the back of her earlobes, pressing slightly on the thin cartilage of the skin while she moved up to the tips of her pointy ears.

Then, suddenly, she dropped her hands and turned away, as if trying to flee the moment she realized there wasn't anything left for her to do.

"Alright, it's fine. Let's move on before it gets dark."

"Hold on, isn't there a place you forgot to check, though? You should be thorough in your work."

Castaspella made the mistake of looking back and she didn't miss the way Shadow Weaver had spread out her legs, feet pointed out, to encourage her to look at the inside of her thighs and between them.

Surely, one controlled by Prime wouldn't be making such provocative proposals. The allies that they had seen fall were much more robotic in their demeanors, prone to talk about the light of Prime's salvation rather than making innuendos. At this point, even if the mask was already back on her face and hiding her expression, Castaspella didn't need any more proof that Shadow Weaver was herself. No, she hadn't been needing it for quite some time already.

And yet, she had still touched her to assuage whatever doubts she convinced herself she had, when it was actually more a matter of showing off to Shadow Weaver that she didn't fear her or her schemes.

She rose to the provocation this time too. Calmly, firmly, best as she could, Castaspella walked up to her and put a hand to her thighs. She pictured the muscles of her face and tried to control them to be still as marble, expressionless just like the smooth surface of the mask in front of her. Then she moved her fingers up, brushed alongside sparse dark air and against soft flesh. She wasn't sue whether the slight wetness she felt should have been considered a victory of some kind or if she should have been disgusted. Shaming Shadow Weaver for her depravity would come with the risk of her retorting back in kind and Castaspella was very much conscious of the wetness that had appeared between her own legs.

Pulling her other hand up to get it over with faster, she moved behind Shadow Weaver's back grabbed onto her ass, feeling up the skin between the cheeks. She wanted it to be a cold, methodical gesture but it was hard to determine that with how warm and full the flesh felt under her outstretched fingers.

She ended her examination of the genitals by drifting to the other thigh, as if it had only been a brief stop to a larger design, barely deserving of interest. She even kneeled down to look along the length of Shadow Weaver's whole leg and under the sole of her right foot, then the other.

"There, it's done. Now, I trust you've completed your surveying and we can safely enter Mystacor?" Castaspella breathed out, at the end of her patience.

Shadow Weaver took her robes off the ground and started putting them back on.

"I did. However, we need to check one last thing before we're able to go," she said while adjusting her fingerless gloves around her hands.

"What more now?!"

"You."

Castaspella looked at the woman in front of her with bafflement. She couldn't even understand what she was getting at.

"What do you mean, me? I've already been checked by the others back then!"

"Only your neck. If I had to go through a detailed examination, it only seems fair that the same would apply to you."

Profanities almost slipped through Castaspella's lips. She bit them back at the last moment, teeth scraping her tongue in the process. So this was what Shadow Weaver had in mind from the start. What a ridiculous concept it was, she couldn't seriously think Castaspella would keep following her twisted schemes to that point.

"I am not going to undress in front of you and let you touch me. You cannot dare to expect that from me. And I didn't make you

go through anything, you're the one who proposed it and had me do that!"

"Why, you talk like I forced you to act but it's not like you had to follow my proposal. You could have refused or stopped at any time, isn't that right?"

"I needed to know I could trust you! And now we've lost enough time with all this; we have to go to Mystacor immediately."

"Which is why we should take care of this quickly so I can fully trust you too. Unless you would prefer me to go there by myself?"

This earned her a snort from Castaspella. How typical of Shadow Weaver it was, to offer two terrible alternatives to unnerve her target, as if there weren't plenty of other possible choices to go with. She retorted with the first one she could think of.

"You just have to cast a truth spell on me, if you want to verify my allegiances."

"Don't be silly, that wouldn't do. It's a piece of cake to deflect that spell for a talented sorceress like yourself."

"Spare me the backhanded flattery."

Crossing her arms, Castaspella held her ground. Around them, the shadows of the forest were getting bigger while the sun moved closer to the horizon. Shadow Weaver sighed.

"We're getting nowhere, how about making some compromises?"

"Like what?"

"I won't touch you. I'll simply look at you, is that alright? I understand the uncomfortable nature of standing in all your nakedness but you have nothing to be shy or ashamed about, unlike this old woman here."

Despite the seemingly humble tone, Castaspella couldn't help but feel like she heard a bit of laughter hidden behind the words. Shadow Weaver didn't care one bit about having exposed her body to scrutiny and she was probably enjoying the idea of humiliating her in return.

Still, Castaspella knew that it would be hard to make her budge more than a few inches. Perhaps it was better to cut her losses there; she was tired and they couldn't waste any more of the little time they had fighting. With a deft gesture from her hands, she modeled the sparkling lines of an hourglass out of thin air.

"I'll agree on the condition this will be limited to an agreed period. You said we had to do it quickly, so I trust you'll manage to keep it short."

"Fine by me. How long, five minutes?"

"Three."

Shadow Weaver leaned her head to the side, then nodded.

In truth, Castaspella wished she could have said much less than that but it would have probably only led to them debating longer about what was a decent time span for a full check.

She shivered while putting away her enchanted tiara, having trouble believing what she was actually about to do. The very thought of Shadow Weaver staring at her naked body felt so mortifying her blood ran cold in her veins. And yet, at the same time, the arousal that had been teasing her flesh still remained and her trembling increased at the frightening possibility it would be noticed by Shadow Weaver.

Taking off her shoulder pads gave her some trouble, the emotional pressure reinforcing the difficulty of removing that bit of armor. She let it drop with her cape and then sighed, giving herself a second of pause before slipping out of her dress.

The hourglass spun around the moment the fabric hit the ground and magical sand started glittering down it like falling stars. Castaspella's hands shuddered, resisting with difficulty the urge to cover what little parts of herself her arms might hide. Shadow Weaver had hummed softly at her sight, in a tone she couldn't quite ascertain whether it was appreciation or mockery. She loathed both options anyway.

It was a real challenge to remain imperturbable under this scrutiny. The cold air of the evening didn't help with her shaking but she was almost grateful for it, since it gave her an excuse for her physical reaction, would Shadow Weaver try to taunt her about it.

"Raise your arms, if you please."

Scoffing at the affected politeness, she followed the demand nonetheless. It felt awkward to hold them up, even more so once Shadow Weaver walked to her so she could inspect from up close. The eerie light coming from behind her mask's slits was disturbing but perhaps preferable to a more direct gaze, since it showed little emotion.

After turning a few times around her, Shadow Weaver stopped at her back, leaving Castaspella anxiously waiting for what was to come next.

"Would you mind spreading your legs a bit further? I can't get a good view of everything."

Swallowing the saliva that was gathering inside her mouth with annoyance, Castaspella shifted her feet's position by a few centimeters.

"No, I'm afraid that's not quite enough. I still can't fully see your bottom, how about pulling that to show it better to me?"

Teeth grinding together and knuckles whitening from the tension exerced by her taunt muscles, Castaspella then moved her hands at her back and to her ass, closing her eyes with the faint hope it

would make her humiliation more bearable. She pulled on the fat, spreading her cheeks for Shadow Weaver to see.

The light sound of footsteps behind her startled Castaspella badly. Shadow Weaver had come closer yet again and having her at her back, silent while she desperately shut her eyes, stirred up wild thoughts inside her mind.

She imagined what it would feel like, if Shadow Weaver betrayed her promise and were to touch her, long clawy fingers running down her spine. Perhaps it would be subtle but perhaps she would immediately aim for the spot between her legs, whether in the front or back. Her own hands were still spreading her ass out for her, making it easy to take advantage of. Just thinking of all that made Castaspella's flesh tense and squeeze under her sweating skin. Surely, Shadow Weaver wouldn't be missing one bit of her reactions.

There was the sound of another step, but moving away from her this time, and then yet another. The damn sorcerer was moving around her once more.

Castaspella quickly opened her eyes, before Shadow Weaver could see how much at her mercy she had been in this moment. Relief that nothing had happened flowed inside her stomach, spinning sickeningly with so many other conflicting emotions. A brief look at the magical hourglass told her she still had over one minute to keep up like this and she couldn't tell if time had been passing too slowly or fast enough.

After getting in front of her again, Shadow Weaver bent down and kneeled on the ground, right at the level of her thighs.

"You can spread your legs. And don't forget to show me the sole of your feet."

It was so humiliating; Castaspella's skin burned and prickled at her with each word. She rose one leg and found it quite hard to keep her equilibrium in this stressful position. Awkwardly, she

shifted the limb into a good position to present the inside of her foot to Shadow Weaver, then quickly put it down before she risked stumbling and hopping around ridiculously to avoid falling.

Much in the same way, she showed her other foot and then, having nothing left she could do and still around thirty seconds before this all would be over, she spread herself for Shadow Weaver to see.

Castaspella could feel the wetness building between her legs, so there was no doubt it would be visible to one who looked, glistening on skin red and warm with arousal. Given how close Shadow Weaver stood, she might even have been able to smell it. And if it weren't for that mask, she would only have to lean forwards to touch it with her lips or worse, with a slithering tongue that Castaspella imagined unusually long and slimy.

The thought had her squirming and she silently cursed herself for letting her thoughts wander in such a direction.

"Are you done?" she asked, her tone almost begging, desperate for all this to be over.

"Pull yourself up just a bit more open," Shadow Weaver gestured at her while answering.

There were only a few seconds left. If she had just waited, Castaspella could have perhaps avoided this. But she was too flustered to realize that right then and she obeyed, pushing on the puffy skin of her labia with the tip of her fingers to expose herself fully.

With a click of the tongue, Shadow Weaver leaned further to stare at her intently. Perhaps she was intending to touch her, just like Castaspella had feared, and this despite the mask standing between them. Holding out her breath, she could already picture the feeling of the hard, cold texture of it brushing against her warm, sensitive skin. The wait was killing her.

After standing still as a statue for an indescribable amount of time, Shadow Weaver broke her stance, not to reach out but to rise up and get away.

"Very well. Time's up, we should get going quickly."

Indeed, the sand in the magic hourglass had all gone to the bottom, probably many seconds before Shadow Weaver had stopped staring too. If only Castaspella had been more conscious of it, she could have ended this earlier.

But she hadn't and perhaps had even secretly hoped for her foe to be quicker at the scheme she was surely planning, to spare her all this painful anticipation.

Had Castaspella allowed Shadow Weaver to touch her, this would have surely gone very differently. The physical examination of her body would have been infinitely more thorough and humiliating than the one Castaspella had done herself. Yet, it might have also eased the ache she still felt between her legs.

Shaking her head, she tried to get rid of the intrusive thoughts. The stupid arousal was driving her mad. She couldn't, she wasn't allowed to regret having kept strong.

Her pride in pieces, Castaspella blew her magic away with an angry swipe of the arm. She picked up her clothes and started to put them on in a hurry. Shadow Weaver was already moving past he end of the clearing, pushing her to follow while half-dressed, nearly tripping in trying to put back her shoes mid-walk.

Calling up to her to wait wasn't an option in those conditions. It would only make the shame burn harder inside her and Castaspella wanted to forget about it quickly.

Thinking of what she'd have to say about their journey to Mystacor to the others, if they even managed to come back, she hoped they wouldn't ask too many questions.

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